

StepCat Quick Start Guide

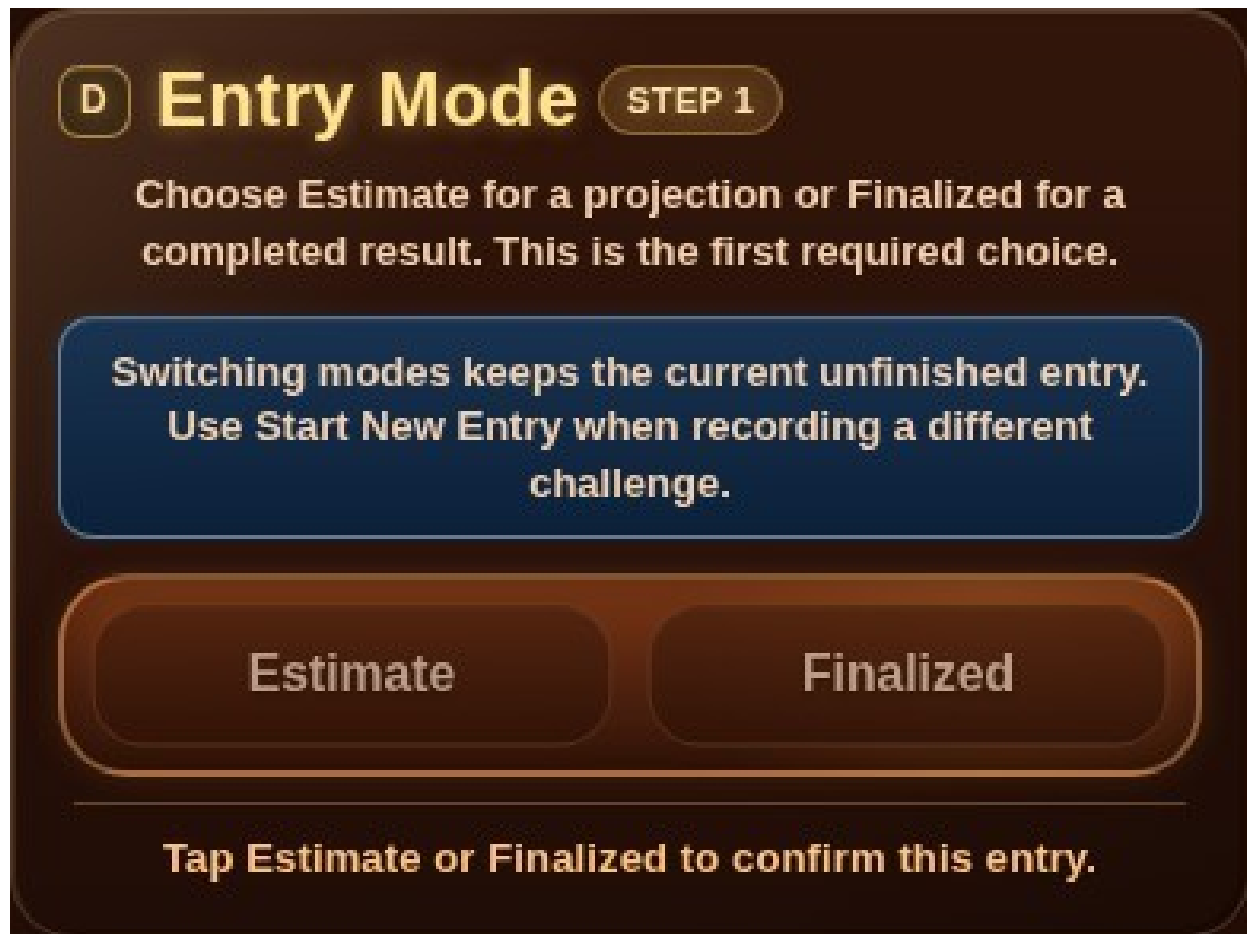
Illustrated app and workbook guide - v251.1

Use the current Entry Mode-first workflow, save an Estimate or Finalized result, and transfer the matching A-M row into the StepCat workbook.

This corrected v251.1 rebuild adds unsaved-entry confirmation, completed-draft cleanup, permanent SC Record IDs, Free Game fee validation, targeted Estimate-finalization scrolling, safer drawer-state handling, matching Record Review warnings, and refreshed documentation.

1. Choose Entry Mode first

Tap Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed result. Then confirm Member or Non-Member . These are the first required choices.



Entry Mode is Step 1 and begins unselected.



The screenshot shows a dark-themed interface for selecting a membership type. At the top center is a gold trophy icon. Below it, the title "Membership Type" is displayed in large gold letters, preceded by a gold letter "E" in a rounded square. To the right of the title is a gold button labeled "Select first". Below the title, a gold button labeled "STEP 2" is shown. A line of text reads: "Member Estimate: the full Gross Pot is divided by Eligible Players." Below this is a rounded rectangle containing two options: "Non-Member" with a person icon and "Member" with a star icon. A horizontal slider bar is positioned below these options, with the "Member" side being highlighted in gold. Below the slider, the formula "Estimated Earned = Gross Pot ÷ Eligible Players" is displayed. Underneath the formula is a gold checkmark icon followed by the text "Member selected for this entry". At the bottom of the rounded rectangle is a large gold button labeled "Show Math".

E **Membership Type** **Select first**

STEP 2

Member Estimate: the full Gross Pot is divided by Eligible Players.

 **Non-Member**  **Member**

Estimated Earned = Gross Pot ÷ Eligible Players

✓ Member selected for this entry

Show Math

Membership Type is Step 2 and confirms Member or Non-Member.

2. Enter the required calculation fields

Game Entry shows required calculation fields first. Estimate requires Gross Pot, Entry Fee, and Eligible Players. Total Players adds context. Finalized also requires Final Earned unless the record is disqualified. Free Game records require a \$0 Entry Fee.

Tap any **i** information button for field help. Blocking validation still appears beside the affected field, under Calculate & Save, and in one brief toast.

Game Entry

Required calculation fields appear first.
Optional game and record information
can stay collapsed until needed.

Inputs auto-save on this device, but
remembered values require a fresh
membership confirmation after
reload.

Entry Mode and Membership Type confirmed.
Complete the fields that apply.

Game & Record Information

Calculation Information

Estimate uses Entry Fee, Gross Pot,
and Eligible Players. Total Players
adds player-history context.

G Gross Pot Required in Estimate **i**

Gross Pot

H Entry Fee Required **i**

Entry Fee

I Eligible Players Required in Estimate **i**

Eligible Players

J Total Players Optional **i**

Total Players

M Notes Optional **i**

Optional notes, e.g.
Original entry: \$13.85 cash
and 26.15 points

Compact Game Entry with required fields first.

3. Open optional Game & Record Information only when needed

Game Name, dates, Date Format, and Payment / Record Type remain collapsed until needed. Notes stays available for optional details such as a Hybrid cash-and-points breakdown.

The screenshot displays the 'Game & Record Information' screen in the StepCat app. It features five main sections, each with a lettered header (A-F), a title, and an 'Optional' or 'Web' indicator. Section A, 'Game Name', shows 'Summer Step Challenge'. Section B, 'Game Start Date', shows '07/01/2026' with a calendar icon and a confirmation message 'Selected start date: 07-01-2026'. Section C, 'Game End Date', shows '07/29/2026' with a calendar icon and a confirmation message 'Selected end date: 07-29-2026'. Section D, 'Date Format', is marked 'Web' and shows 'MM-DD-YYYY' with a dropdown arrow and a 'Not copied' status. Section E, 'Payment / Record Type', is marked 'Optional*' and shows 'Cash'. Each section also includes an information icon (i).

A Game Name Optional i
Summer Step Challenge

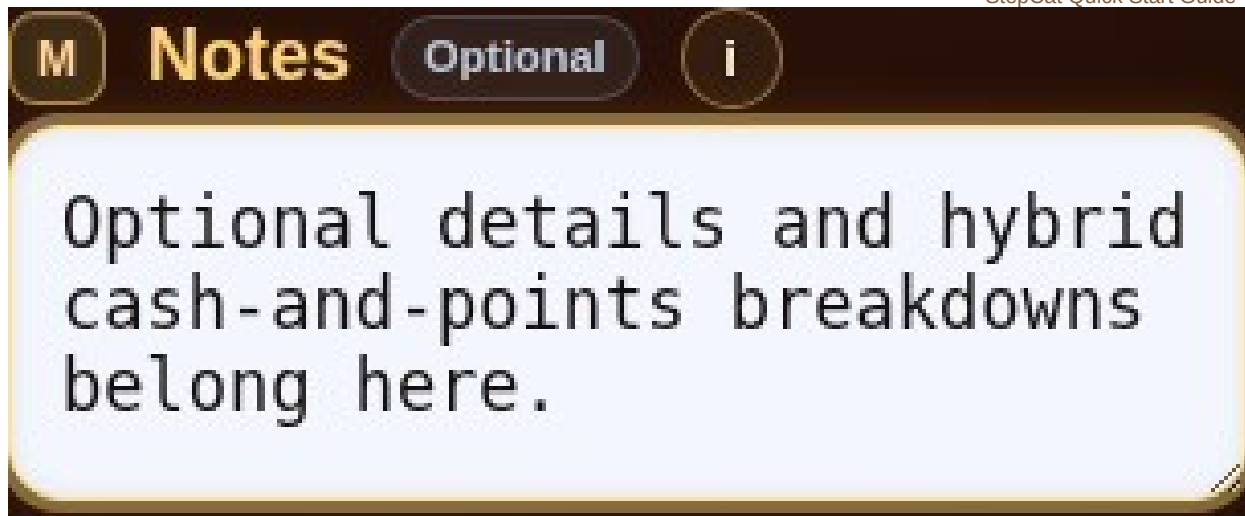
B Game Start Date Optional i
07/01/2026
Selected start date: 07-01-2026

C Game End Date Optional i
07/29/2026
Selected end date: 07-29-2026

Web Date Format Not copied i
MM-DD-YYYY

F Payment / Record Type Optional* i
Cash

Game & Record Information opened with sample values.



The screenshot shows a dark-themed interface. At the top, there is a header bar with three elements: a yellow circle containing the letter 'M', the word 'Notes' in large yellow font, and a grey pill-shaped button labeled 'Optional'. To the right of the 'Optional' button is a circular icon containing a lowercase 'i'. Below the header is a large, light blue rectangular text area with rounded corners and a thin yellow border. Inside this area, the text 'Optional details and hybrid cash-and-points breakdowns belong here.' is written in a monospaced font.

Optional Notes field with contextual help.

4. Complete a Finalized result

In Finalized mode, the disqualification control appears immediately before Final Earned / Chips. Its neutral state reads Not Disqualified . When selected, it turns into a warning state, sets Final Earned to 0.00, and locks the field until switched off.



Finalized status control and required Final Earned field.

FINALIZED STATUS

L Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee

Not Disqualified ☒

K Final Earned / Chips

Required in Finalized **i**

12

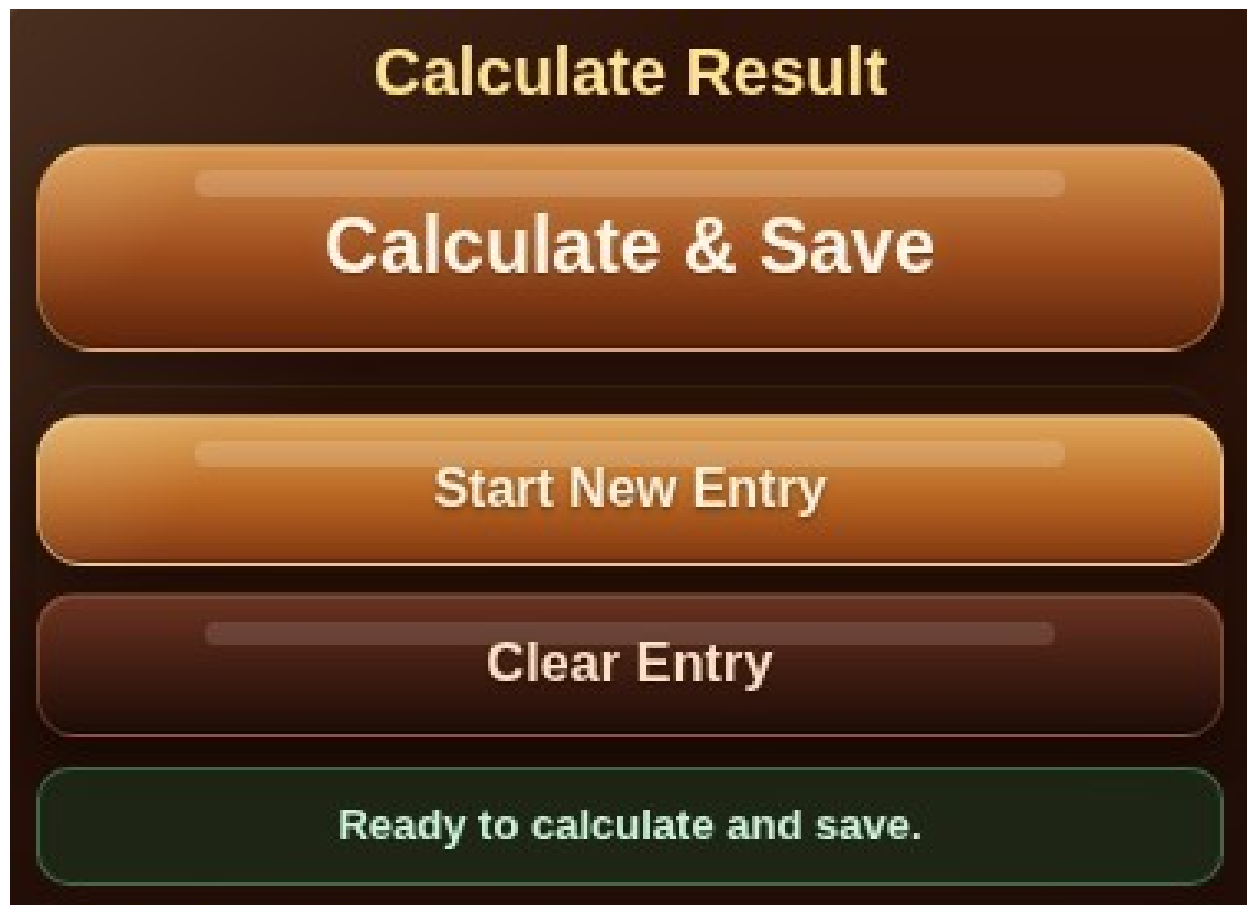
Final Earned entered for a normal finalized result.



Active Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee warning state.

5. Calculate, save, or begin a new entry

Calculate & Save validates and stores one result, then clears the completed form so it cannot return as an unfinished draft. Start New Entry and Clear Entry ask for confirmation whenever meaningful unsaved content exists. Restore Cleared Fields can recover a deliberately cleared form during the same session.



Calculate & Save with Start New Entry and Clear Entry actions.

6. Review or finalize the Saved History card

Estimate cards show projected earnings while Accounting Result and ROI remain N/A. Every Saved History card has a permanent, non-editable StepCat Record ID such as SC-0023. Individual deletion offers a brief Undo action. Clear History creates one dated backup, and Restore History is allowed only while Saved History is empty. Tap Finalize This Estimate when the game ends. The finalization dialog asks only for completed information, updates the same record in place, and returns to the updated card.

Entry Fee	Gross Pot	Players	Eliminated	Estimated Break-Even Point	Current Position
	\$100000	100 eligible of 120	20 - 16.7%	100 eligible players	At the estimated break-even point

Estimate card with projection and Finalize This Estimate.

Finalize This Estimate dialog.

Saved Result

Delete

FinalizedMemberProfit

Copy This Sheet Row

FINAL EARNED
\$12.00

PROFIT
\$2.00

ROI
20.0%

Entry F

Estimate finalized.
Existing record updated.

Gross Pot

\$1,000.00

Players

100 eligible of 120

Eliminated

20 - 16.7%

Estimated Earned

\$10.00

Difference from Estimate

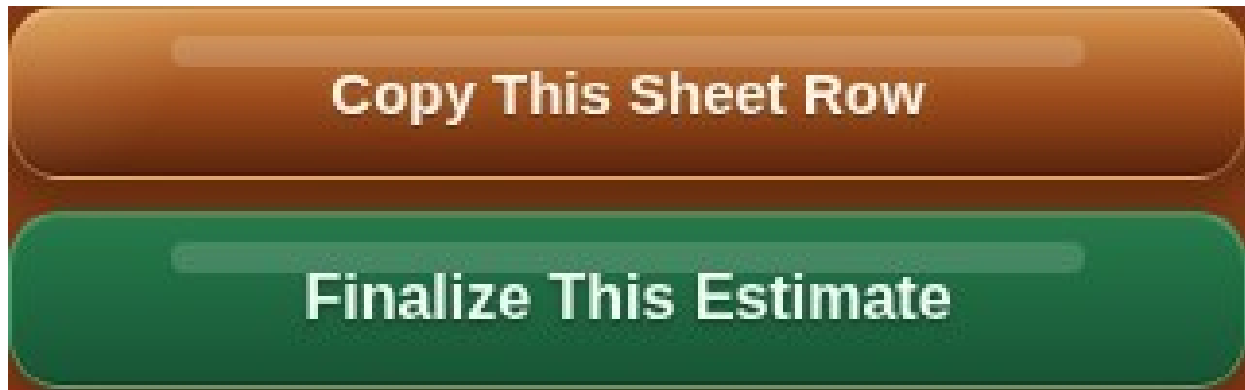
+\$2.00

The same history record updated to Finalized.

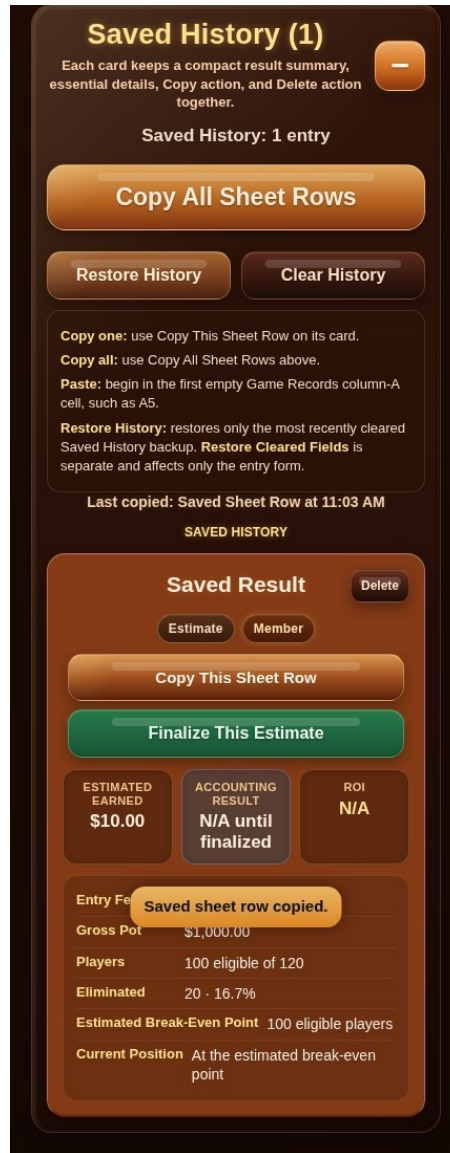
7. Copy the result into the workbook

Tap Copy This Sheet Row, open Game Records, select the first empty cell in column A, and paste. Named records copy normally. When Game Name was left blank, StepCat uses a unique fallback such as Unnamed Game — SC-0023. Copy All Sheet Rows transfers all saved A–M records without a header row because row 4 already contains workbook headers.

Paste in A–M only. Never overwrite formula columns N–Z.



Copy This Sheet Row and Finalize This Estimate actions.



Copy confirmation and Saved History context.

8. Use the StepCat-themed workbook

The workbook uses the app palette while preserving spreadsheet cues: pale gold/cream for user input, blue-gray for protected formulas, green for Profit, gray for Draw, blue for Estimate, yellow for Free Game, and red for losses or warnings.

	A	B
1	StepCat Workbook Instructions — v251.1	Matching StepCat app and profitability workbook release.
2		Use the StepCat palette: gold/cream identifies user-entered information, blue-gray identifies protected formulas, green marks positive results, and red marks losses or warnings.
3	START HERE	Enter or paste every new game into the next blank Game Records row, beginning at row 5.
4	Editable columns	Enter or paste values only in columns A-M. Formula columns N-Z calculate automatically.
5	Entry Mode	Use Estimate for a projection and Finalized for a completed result. Estimate rows remain outside finalized cash accounting.
6	Membership Type	Choose Member or Non-Member when known. Non-Member estimates use 85% of the Gross Pot after the 15% deduction.
7	Payment / Record Type	Use Cash, Points, Hybrid, Free Game, or Subscription — membership charge only, as appropriate.
8	Copying from StepCat	Copy This Sheet Row transfers one A-M record. Copy All Sheet Rows transfers all saved A-M records without a header row.
9	Finalizing an estimate	Replace the same game's existing A-M worksheet values with the finalized A-M values. Do not add a duplicate row for the same game.
10	Capacity	Rows 5-504 are prepared. Row 505 is the archive boundary; begin a new workbook before entering beyond it.
11	ACCOUNTING RULES	These rules apply consistently in the app, Game Records, Summary, and reports.
12	Profit	A finalized paid game is Profit only when Result Earned / Chips is greater than Entry Fee.
13	Draw	A normal finalized paid return equal to or below Entry Fee is a Draw with \$0.00 Net Profit.
14	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee	A paid disqualification records \$0.00 Result Earned / Chips and loses the full Entry Fee.
15	Free Game	Free Game returns are chips or game credit. ROI is N/A and cash Net Profit remains \$0.00.
16	Estimate	Estimate rows show the exact projection, Result = Estimate, and N/A in finalized accounting fields.
17	Running Net Game Profit	Gross Profit Earned minus Total Lost Entry Fees. Estimate rows and Free Game chips do not change this cash total.
18	Running Net Profit (Column Z)	Cumulative Net Game Profit including the carryover amount below. Estimate and subscription rows carry the preceding total forward rather than posting a game result.
19	Membership / subscription fees	Subscription rows are non-game costs. They are excluded from Games by Result and tracked separately on Summary.
20	Actual Running Net Profit	Running Net Game Profit minus membership/subscription fees. This is the closest overall cash-profit figure.
21		
22	WORKBOOK STRUCTURE	The workbook uses one input table, protected formula columns, a review sheet, and live reports.
23	Game Records A-M	User-entered or copied fields. Pale gold identifies the editable area.
24	Game Records N-Z	Protected calculation fields. Blue-gray identifies formulas that should not be overwritten.
25	Formula-ready rows	Rows 5-504 contain formulas, formatting, and validation. Row 505 marks the archive boundary.
26	Record Review	Shows Complete or Needs Info and identifies missing required data without adding extra Game Records columns.
27	Reports	Summary, Game Comparisons, and Best Results update from finalized Game Records and use readable blank-state messages.
28		
29	Carryover Net Game Profit	\$0.00
30	Carryover note	Enter a prior workbook's verified Net Game Profit here only when intentionally continuing totals in a new copy.
31		
32	COLOR KEY	The colors follow the StepCat web app while retaining useful green/yellow spreadsheet cues.
33	User input	Pale gold / cream
34	Formula / protected	Pale blue-gray
35	Profit	Light green

Upper Instructions sheet with consistent coded rows.

	A	B
36	Draw	Light gray
37	Estimate	Light blue
38	Free Game	Pale yellow
39	Subscription	Blue
40	Disqualified / Loss	Light red
41	VALIDATION & TROUBLESHOOTING	Yellow input cells and inline review messages identify information that may need attention.
42	VALIDATION & TROUBLESHOOTING	Correct the listed Game Records fields; formulas and reports update automatically.
43		
44	Missing Game Type	Enter Member or Non-Member when known. Unclassified finalized games remain visible in Game Comparisons.
45	Missing Final Earned	Finalized rows require Final Earned / Chips unless Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee is Yes.
46	Missing Estimate inputs	Estimate rows require Gross Pot, Entry Fee, and Eligible Players.
47	Dates and player counts	End Date cannot precede Start Date. Eligible Players and Total Players must be positive whole numbers, and Eligible Players cannot exceed Total Players.
48	Formula recovery	If a formula cell is accidentally overwritten, copy the matching N-Z formula from an adjacent working row, then verify Record Review and totals.
49		
50	ESTIMATE FINALIZATION	Use the app's Finalize This Estimate action or replace the same worksheet row manually.
51	Same record	The finalized result should keep the same game identity and replace the estimate rather than creating a second record.
52	No duplicate accounting	Do not retain both an Estimate row and a second Finalized row for the same game in Game Records.
53	App workflow	Finalize This Estimate asks only for the completed information while retaining the original pot, fee, players, membership, dates, and record type.
54		
55	GOOGLE SHEETS & COPYING	Use values-only A-M transfers and preserve the formula area.
56	Paste target	Select the first empty cell in column A and paste. Do not enter cell-edit mode before pasting.
57	Inserted rows	Insert a row from inside the native table when adding a forgotten game in chronological order.
58	Values only	When migrating from an older workbook, copy only populated A-M values; do not copy headers, reports, or whole sheets.
59	Protect formulas	Never clear or overwrite N-Z. Those columns calculate results, comparisons, and running totals.
60		
61	REPORTS & FEES	Finalized game results and non-game costs are deliberately separated.
62	Games by Result	The Summary chart and tally show exact Profit, Draw, and Disqualified counts; subscriptions are excluded.
63	Membership fees	Subscription / membership charges are tracked separately and subtracted only from Actual Running Net Profit.
64	Empty reports	When no qualifying records exist, report tables show a clear blank-state message rather than a misleading None category.
65	RELEASE & MIGRATION	v251.1 adds the revised app workflow, estimate finalization, StepCat-themed workbook colors, repaired instruction formatting, readable headers, and exact result tallies.

Lower Instructions sheet with validation, finalization, copying, and reports.

9. Enter A–M and leave N–Z intact

Rows 5–504 are formula-ready. Row 505 is the archive boundary. The taller row 4 headers wrap without clipping. Record Review identifies missing information, formula problems, and invalid Free Game rows that contain a non-zero Entry Fee.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1													
2													
3	A-M — Inputs only												
4	Game Name	Start Date	End Date	Entry Mode	Game Type	Payment / Record Type	Gross Pot	Entry Fee	Eligible Players	Total Players	Final Earned / Chips	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee	Notes
5				▼	▼	▼						▼	
6				▼	▼	▼						▼	
7				▼	▼	▼						▼	
8				▼	▼	▼						▼	
9				▼	▼	▼						▼	
10				▼	▼	▼						▼	
11				▼	▼	▼						▼	
12				▼	▼	▼						▼	

Game Records input columns A–M.

	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
1	Entry Fees: \$0.00 StepCat v251.1												
2	Do not change cash totals until finalized. Archive at row 505.												
3	N-Z — Formula columns — do not edit												
4	Adjusted Pot	Estimated Earned	Result Earned / Chips	Profit	Draw	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee	ROI	Result	Challenge Length (Weeks)	Net Profit	Eliminated Players	Elimination Rate	Running Net Profit
5													
6													
7													
8													
9													
10													
11													
12													

Protected formula columns N–Z.

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	StepCat Record Review — v251.1					
2	This sheet updates automatically. Correct missing information on Game Records in columns A–M only; do not edit formula columns N–Z.					
3						
4	Game Records Row	Game Name	Current Result	Data Status	Missing Information	What Will Update
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						

Record Review with clear Complete or Needs Info status.

10. Read the reports

Summary gives exact Profit, Draw, and Disqualified counts, excludes subscriptions from Games by Result, and tracks membership fees separately. Game Comparisons separates completed paid games from Estimates, Free Games, and subscriptions. Best Results uses readable blank-state messages.

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N
StepCat Live Summary Dashboard — v251.1													
Finalized game results, Estimate rows, Free Games, and membership/subscription costs are deliberately separated.													
Game Result		Exact Count	Share	Financial Metric	Value	Games by Result — Exact Counts							
Profit Games	0		0.0%	Net Game Profit	\$0.00	Gross profit minus lost entry fees							
Draw Games	0		0.0%	Gross Profit Earned	\$0.00	Positive game profit before losses or fees							
Disqualified Games	0		0.0%	Total Lost Entry Fees	\$0.00	Full paid entry fees lost							
Total Completed Paid Games	0		0.0%	Membership / Subscription Fees	\$0.00	Tracked separately as non-game costs							
				Actual Running Net Profit	\$0.00	Net Game Profit minus membership fees							
Other Record Type		Exact Count	Meaning										
Estimate Rows			finalized										
Free Games			accounting credit excluded										
Subscription Rows			0 from cash profit excluded from 0 Games by Result										

Summary dashboard and exact result-count chart.

	H	I	J
20			
21	Games by Result		Exact Count
22	Profit		0 Yes
23	Draw		0 Yes
24	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee		0 Yes
25	Total Completed Paid Games		0 —

Exact Games by Result tally.

	A	B	C	D	E
1	Member vs Non-Member Performance — v251.1				
2	Completed paid games only. Estimates, Free Games, and Subscription/Membership Fees are tracked separately below.				
3					
4	Metric	Member	Non-Member	Unclassified	All Completed Paid Games
5	Completed Games	0	0	0	0
6	Profit Games	0	0	0	0
7	Profit Rate	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
8	Draw Rate	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
9	Disqualification Rate	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
10	Average Net Profit	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
11	Average ROI	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
12	Total Net Profit	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
13					
14	Tracked Separately				
15	Estimate Records	0			
16	Free Games	0			
17	Subscription / Membership Fees	0			
18	Records Needing Membership Classification	0			

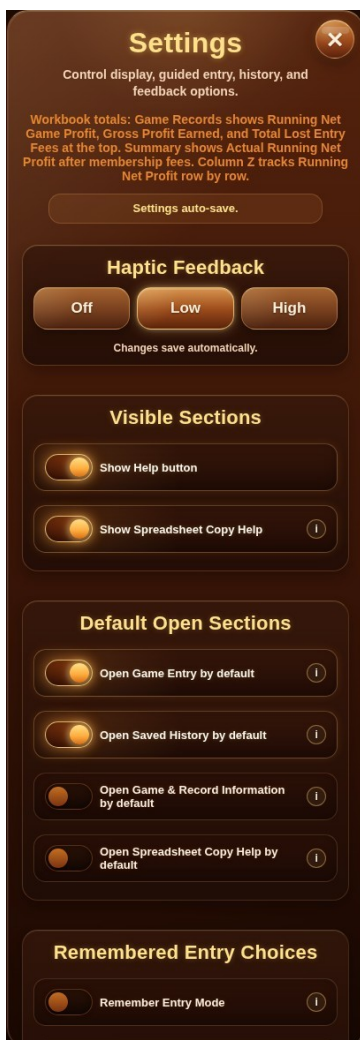
Member vs Non-Member performance with separate non-game counts.

	A	B	C	D
1	Best Results — v251.1			
2	Finalized game results only. Blank-state messages appear until qualifying records exist.			
3				
4	Metric	Game	Value	Meaning
5	Highest Net Profit	No finalized profit games yet	N/A	Largest positive finalized game result
6	Highest ROI	No finalized paid games yet	N/A	Best return on a paid Entry Fee
7	Largest Lost Entry Fee	No paid disqualifications yet	N/A	Largest finalized full-entry loss
8	Lowest Elimination Rate	No elimination data yet	N/A	Best recorded elimination rate
9	Longest Challenge	No dated games yet	N/A	Most weeks completed

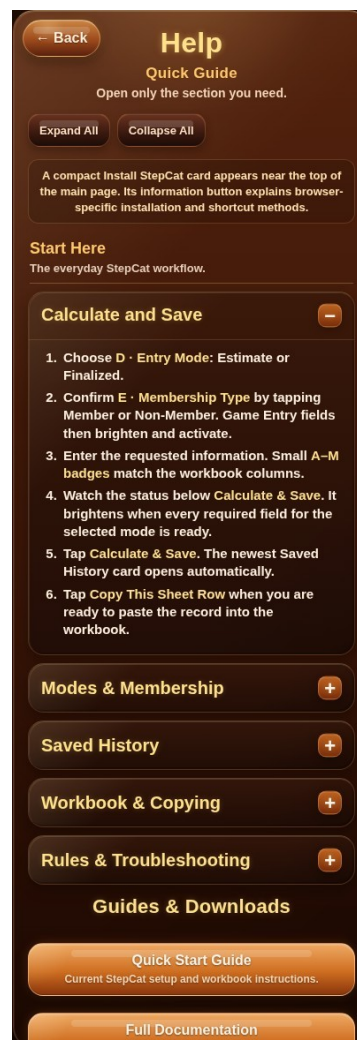
Best Results with readable blank states.

11. Customize Settings and open Help

All setting changes save automatically. Settings can remember Entry Mode, Membership Type, Payment / Record Type, and unfinished Game Entry inputs. Default-open options apply when StepCat next loads or refreshes; they do not override a drawer the user has manually opened or collapsed during the current session. Restore Defaults also returns Haptic Feedback to Low.



Settings with visible sections, default-open sections, and remembered choices.



Help with collapsible sections and Expand All / Collapse All.

Guides & Downloads

Quick Start Guide
Current StepCat setup and workbook instructions.

Full Documentation
Complete StepCat and profitability workbook reference.

Make a Google Sheets Copy
Create your own native StepCat workbook in Google Sheets.

Quick Start Guide — PDF
Open or download the illustrated PDF guide.

Quick Start Guide — Editable DOCX
Download an editable copy for personal reference.

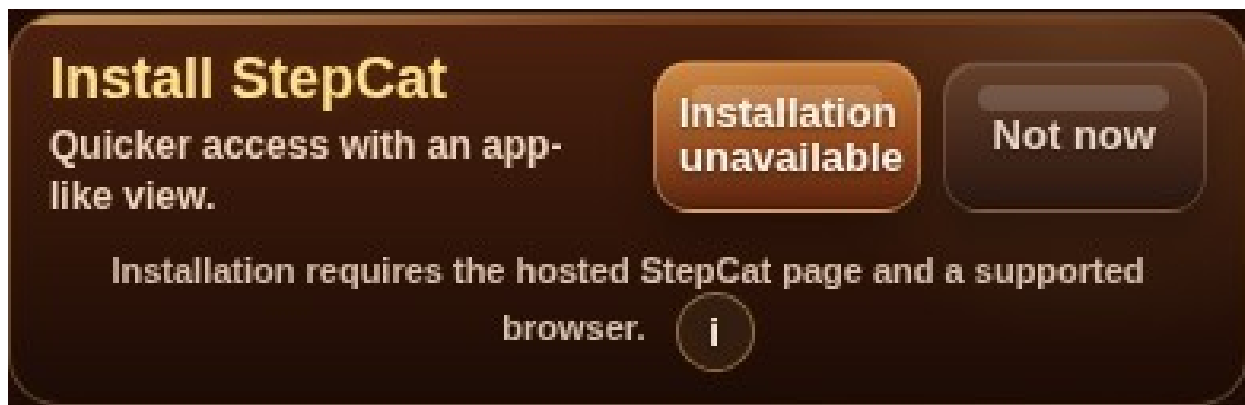
Installation: use the Install StepCat card on the main page when the hosted site and browser support it. ⓘ

Write Feedback
Enter a message; StepCat copies it before opening your email app.

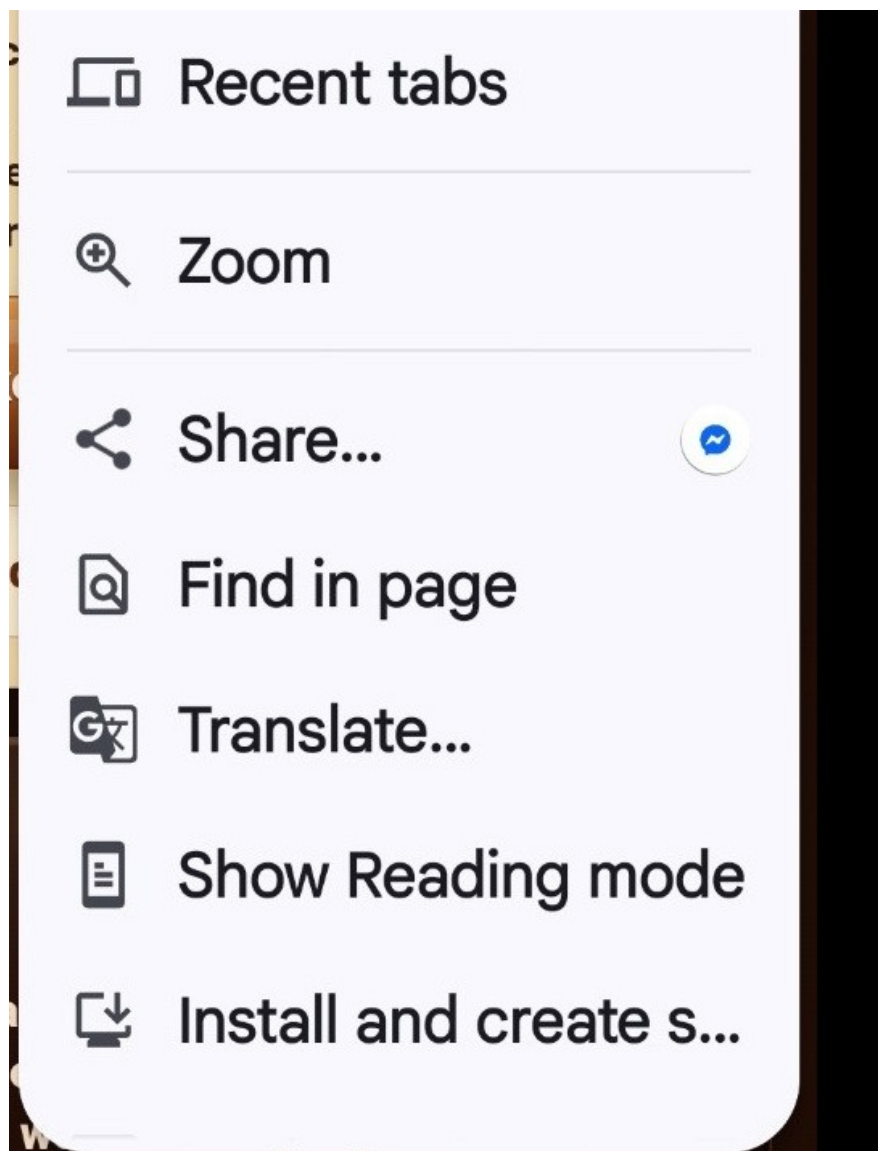
Guides & Downloads with compact installation guidance.

12. Install StepCat or send feedback

The main Install StepCat card reports whether installation is available. Its information button explains Add to Home Screen and shortcut alternatives. Installation must be tested from the hosted page. Feedback prepares a message for the user's email app.



State-aware Install StepCat card with contextual information.



Android Chrome installation or shortcut menu.

Install app



StepCat Calculator
stepcat.netlify.app

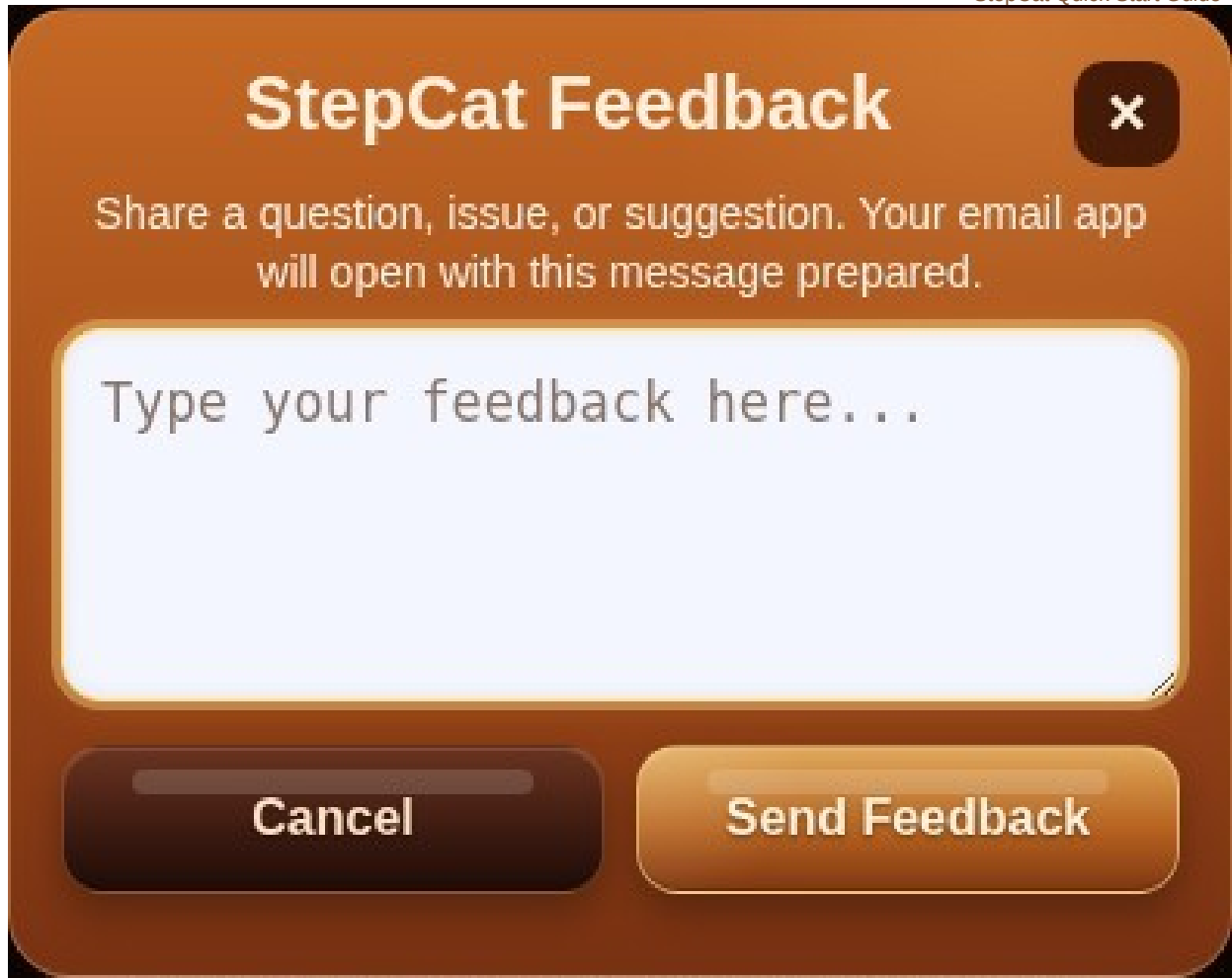
Cancel

Install

Android installation confirmation.



StepCat installed on an Android home screen.

A feedback dialog box with a brown background and rounded corners. At the top, the title "StepCat Feedback" is displayed in white, next to a close button with a white "X". Below the title, a message in white text says "Share a question, issue, or suggestion. Your email app will open with this message prepared." A large, light blue text input field with rounded corners and a thin brown border occupies the center. At the bottom, there are two buttons: a dark brown "Cancel" button on the left and a lighter brown "Send Feedback" button on the right, both with rounded corners and white text.

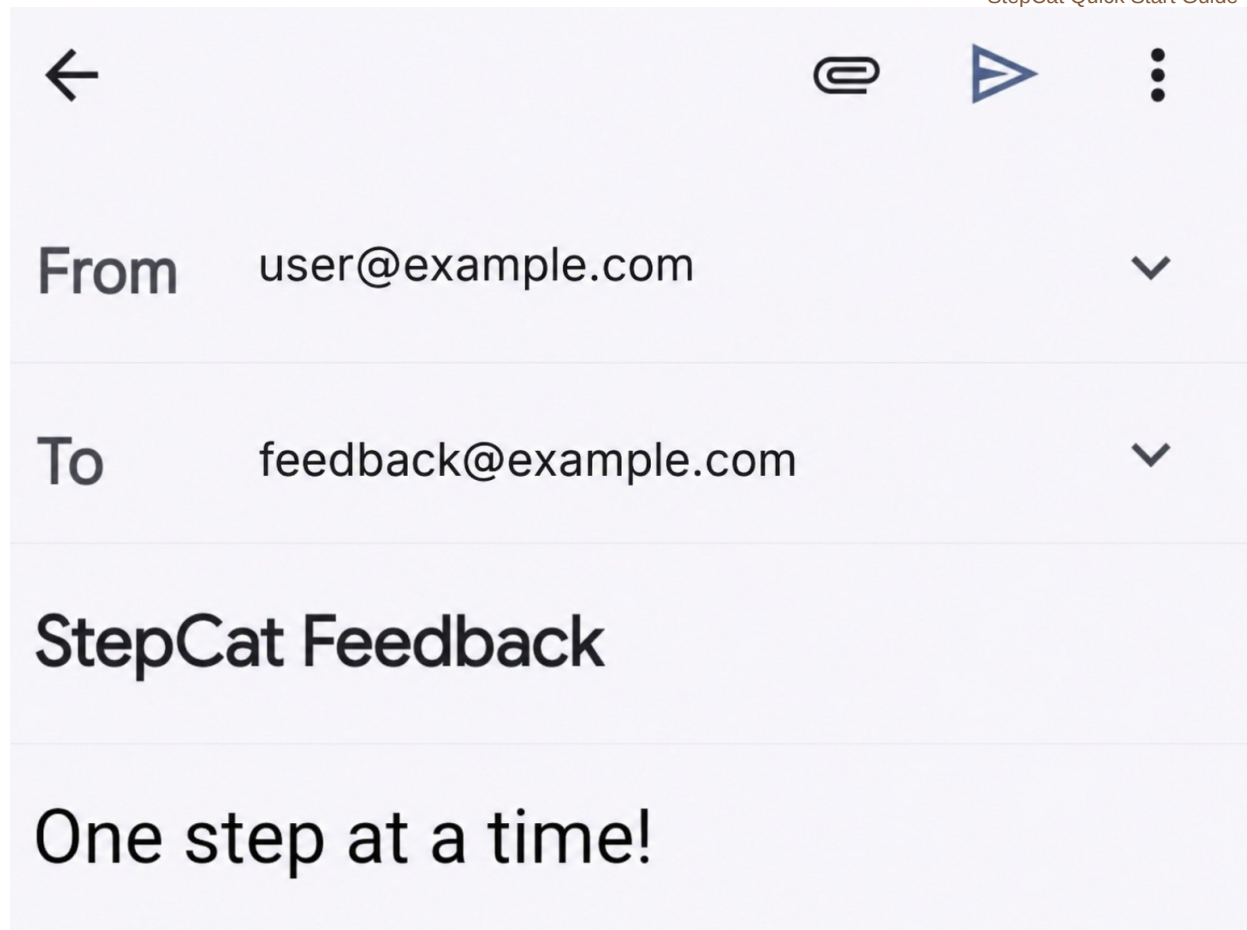
StepCat Feedback ✕

Share a question, issue, or suggestion. Your email app will open with this message prepared.

Type your feedback here...

Cancel **Send Feedback**

Feedback dialog.



Prepared feedback email.

Release and migration notes

This corrected v251.1 rebuild adds unsaved-entry confirmation, completed-draft cleanup, permanent SC Record IDs, Free Game fee validation, targeted Estimate-finalization scrolling, safer drawer-state handling, and matching Record Review warnings. The package remains local until it is deliberately uploaded to GitHub.

1. Keep the older workbook as a backup.
2. Compare the older and v251.1 Game Records A-M headers.
3. Copy populated A-M values only; do not copy whole sheets, headers, Record Review, or N-Z formulas.
4. Verify Record Review, Summary, Game Comparisons, and Best Results before retiring the older workbook.